



SolidAlliance Mnemosyne

The SolidAlliance Mnemosyne is a \$10,000 USB drive that is yet to be released. Despite the price, there is no plug and play feature; you have to solve an aluminium puzzle cube before access is allowed.

Memory Type	Compact Flash							
Brand	Kingston	Kingston	Verbatim	Kingston	SanDisk	SanDisk	SanDisk	Kingston
Model	CF 2GB FE	Ultimate 266X 4GB	CF 4GB	Ultimate 266X 8GB	Extreme IV Compact Flash 16GB	Extreme III Compact Flash 16GB	Extreme III Compact Flash 32GB	Elite Pro 133X 32GB
Formatted Capacity (MB)	1,925	3,789	3,830	7,752	15,617	15,564	31,256	30,720
File Transfer Test (512 MB)								
Performance	Sequential Write Time (s)	85.5	24.6	64.1	24.9	22.9	30.9	35.9
	Sequential Write Speed (MBps)	5.99	20.81	7.99	20.56	22.36	16.57	14.26
	Sequential Read Time (s)	40.7	21	21.6	20.8	20.2	23.6	21.1
	Sequential Read Speed (MBps)	12.58	24.38	23.7	24.62	25.35	21.69	24.27
	Assorted Write Time (s)	177.6	33.7	116.1	36.5	38.8	47.9	87.1
	Assorted Write Speed (MBps)	2.88	15.19	4.41	14.03	13.2	10.69	5.88
	Assorted Read Time (s)	43.3	30.4	33.6	28.4	33.3	35.8	36.8
	Assorted Read Speed (MBps)	11.82	16.84	15.24	18.03	15.38	14.3	13.91
Price (Rs.)	810	3,921	800	3,435	16,999	8,999	14,499	5,999

Elite Pro 133X 32 GB has a price per GB that's just unmatched. A quick glance at the graph and you can see that although it only offers 75 per cent of the performance score (compared to the best performer), it is only about 18 per cent of the price. The Elite Pro 133X 32 GB is our Best Buy in the CF category.

I will say, however, if you're looking for something smaller

than 32 GB, the Kingston Ultimate 266X 8 GB is the card you should buy – 40 per cent the price for 98 per cent the performance.

MicroSD

Used mostly in mobile phones, these tiny cards are the hottest selling right now. We received three cards in this category – one from Verbatim and two

MICROSD

This category is mainly consumed by mobile phone users. Apart from having to read a large number of assorted files – most of our phones these days store phonebook entries, SMSes, camera images, applications, web pages, and more. However, writing to the flash drive is a rarer occurrence than reading from it. Your special ringtone, or display picture for your significant other, reading SMSes, etc., is how most people use their mobiles.

However, we cannot ignore the fact that most mobile phones these days are being used, in part, as digital cameras, and thus sequential write speeds are also important. To complicate matters further, we also use our mobiles as PMPs, and view videos on them. It's obvious that memory cards for mobiles these days are used a great deal. We consider this order of importance: assorted reads, sequential reads and sequential writes, assorted writes.

Memory Type	Micro SD			
Brand	Verbatim	SanDisk	SanDisk	
Model	Micro SD 2GB	Micro SDHC 8GB	Micro SDHC 16GB	
				
Formatted Capacity (MB)	1,935	7,782	15,155	
File Transfer Test (512 MB)				
Performance	Sequential Write Time (s)	66	41.3	42
	Sequential Write Speed (MBps)	7.76	12.4	12.19
	Sequential Read Time (s)	38.6	29	29.2
	Sequential Read Speed (MBps)	13.26	17.66	17.53
	Assorted Write Time (s)	244.7	55.9	62.7
	Assorted Write Speed (MBps)	2.09	9.16	8.17
	Assorted Read Time (s)	60.8	40.1	42
	Assorted Read Speed (MBps)	8.42	12.77	12.19
Price (Rs.)	500	4,999	6,500	